Seeraa Quest

BOOK ONE

From Arabia Before Islam
to the First Revelation

FEYSEL RESHID

Nine maps. Thirty-six stories.
Read. Reflect. Put good lessons into practice.

About this book

Seeraa Quest: Book One follows the early life and world of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) through nine maps and thirty-six story quests. Read slowly, ask questions and practise one good lesson at a time.

The Prophet and the angels are never pictured. Places, objects and anonymous supporting figures help illustrate the setting. Historical scenes are artistic interpretations, not exact reconstructions.

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Source framework: the Seeraa Quest course and widely taught seerah accounts, including Ar-Raheeq al-Makhtum (The Sealed Nectar). Direct anchors include Qur'an 2:127–129; 61:6; 93:6; 96:1–5; 105:1–5; 74:1–7; Sahih al-Bukhari 1, 3, 4 and 2262; Sahih Muslim 162c. Historical details are presented with appropriate qualifications where reports differ.

The du'a pages identify their Qur'anic sources. English meanings are simple paraphrases; transliteration is a reading aid. The selected prayers connect with each map's lesson and are not claimed to have been spoken during its historical events. Uthmani Arabic: Tanzil Quran Text, Version 1.1, © Tanzil Project (tanzil.net), CC BY 3.0; reproduced unchanged. Qur'anic font: Amiri Quran, SIL Open Font License.

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What is seerah?

Seerah is the study of the life and example of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him). It helps us understand the world in which the Qur'an was revealed and how he taught people to worship Allah and care for one another.

In this book, each map is a group of four story quests. Begin with the picture, read the stories, try the quest check and learn the map's du'a.

Families can read one story at a time. Younger readers can listen and answer aloud; older readers can explain the lesson in their own words. There is no need to rush.

Begin with a good intention

إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ

Before you read, pause and think about why you are learning.

The Prophet taught that actions are judged by intentions. A good intention gives purpose to the effort we make. (Sahih al-Bukhari 1, meaning.)

You might intend: I want to learn the seerah so I can know the Messenger of Allah better, follow his good example and please Allah.

Read with care. Be kind to the person learning beside you. After a story, choose one good action to practise.

Arabia Before Islam

Guidance

STORY 01

Arabia Before Islam

STORY 02

The House of Allah

STORY 03

How the Idols Came

STORY 04

A Society in Need of Guidance

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Notice the desert, the mountains and the water. Why would a well be so important to a traveller?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. Arabia Before Islam

2. The House of Allah

3. How the Idols Came

4. A Society in Need of Guidance

Arabia Before Islam

The land and its people

Imagine wide deserts, rocky mountains and green oases where water helps date palms grow. This is Arabia, a peninsula with seas on three sides. Long ago, some families lived in towns, while Bedouin families travelled with their animals to find water and grass.

Makkah stood in a dry valley. Travellers came to its markets and to the Ka'bah. Other important places included Yathrib, later called Madinah, and Ta'if. Caravans carried goods between distant towns.

A tribe was a large family group that offered protection. The Arabs valued memory, poetry, courage and generosity. Learning about their world helps us understand the changes that Islam would bring.

Reflect: How might you welcome a tired traveller?

The House of Allah

The Ka'bah

The Qur'an tells us that Ibrahim and his son Isma'il raised the foundations of the House. As they worked, they asked Allah to accept their service. The Ka'bah was a place for worshipping Allah alone.

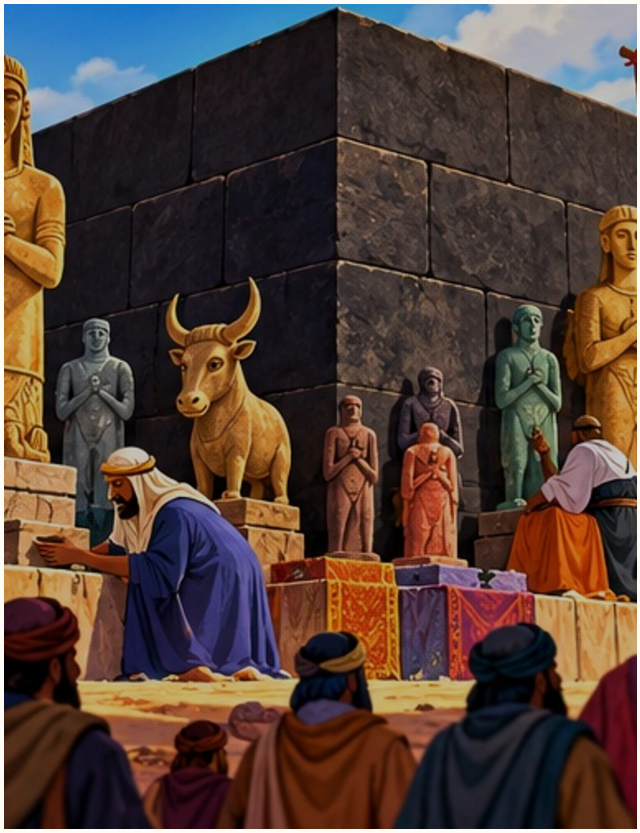
Muslims do not worship the building. We worship Allah, and face the Ka'bah when we pray. Facing one direction brings Muslims together, wherever they live.

In the centuries before the Prophet's message, people added idols around the sanctuary. Its purpose had been forgotten by many. The story of the Ka'bah reminds us to keep our worship sincere.

Reflect: Who do Muslims worship when they face the Ka'bah?

How the Idols Came

Tawhid forgotten



Ibrahim taught people to worship Allah alone. This belief is called tawhid. Over time, many people in Arabia moved away from that teaching and began worshipping idols.

A leader called 'Amr ibn Luhayy brought an idol to Makkah. More idols appeared, until many stood around the Ka'bah. People copied customs without asking whether they were true.

Some people still searched for Ibrahim's pure faith. The truth was not decided by how many people followed a custom. We can learn to ask thoughtful questions and seek guidance from Allah.

Reflect: Does a custom become right just because many people follow it?

A Society in Need of Guidance

Good qualities and serious wrongs

Before Islam, people in Arabia had many good qualities. They welcomed guests, loved poetry and showed courage. Some kept promises even when doing so was difficult.

But there was also serious injustice. Powerful people could mistreat the weak. Orphans and women were often denied their rights. Tribes fought long wars, and some people treated daughters cruelly.

This period is often called al-Jahiliyyah, the time of ignorance. Islam would teach people to worship Allah alone and to protect one another's rights. Courage and generosity would be joined with mercy, fairness and responsibility.

Reflect: What does being fair to someone younger look like?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

We worship Allah alone and ask Him to guide us.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 1 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. What surrounds Arabia on three sides?

A. Seas
B. Forests
C. Snowy mountains

2. Who raised the foundations of the Ka'bah?

A. Ibrahim and Isma'il
B. The kings of Yemen
C. Abrahah's army

3. What does tawhid mean?

A. A trading journey
B. Worshipping Allah alone
C. A family group

4. Which action shows fairness?

A. Taking a younger child's turn
B. Ignoring someone who needs help
C. Protecting a person's rights

5. Why did desert travellers need wells?

A. To mark a race
B. To find drinking water
C. To store clothes

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Al-Fatihah • Qur'an 1:6

ٱهْدِنَا ٱلصِّرَٰطَ ٱلْمُسْتَقِيمَ ٦

MEANING

Guide us along the straight path.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Ihdina s-sirata l-mustaqim.

Ask Allah for guidance as you learn and make choices.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Tell the story of the Ka'bah in your own words.

2. Why did desert travellers need to plan for water?

3. Name a good quality that Islam encourages.

4. Draw or describe one fair action you can do today.

When could you use this map's du'a?

The Prophet's Family

Family and generosity

STORY 01

The Line of Ibrahim

STORY 02

Hashim, Who Shared Bread

STORY 03

'Abd al-Muttalib Finds Zamzam

STORY 04

'Abdullah and Aminah

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Look at the well and the simple tools. How does sharing water help a whole community?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. The Line of Ibrahim

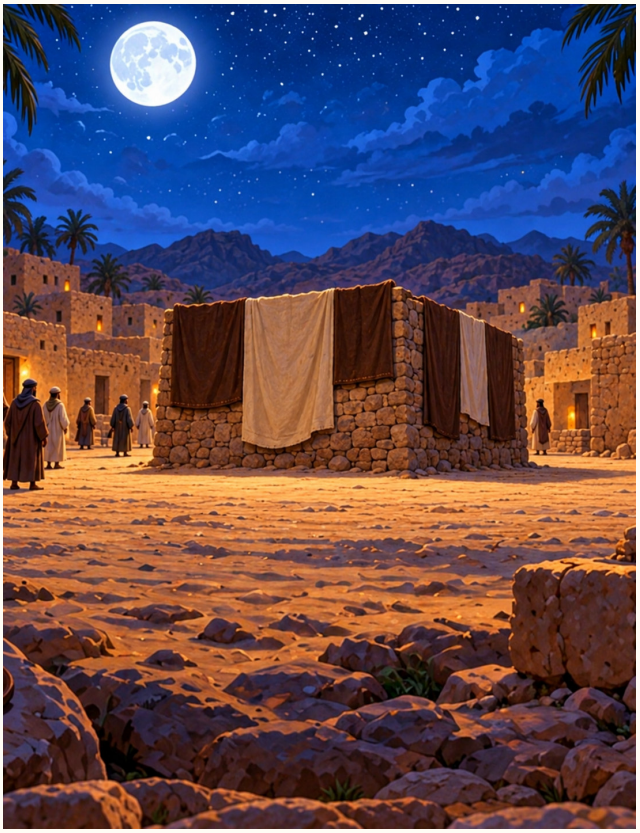
2. Hashim, Who Shared Bread

3. 'Abd al-Muttalib Finds Zamzam

4. 'Abdullah and Aminah

The Line of Ibrahim

A family connection



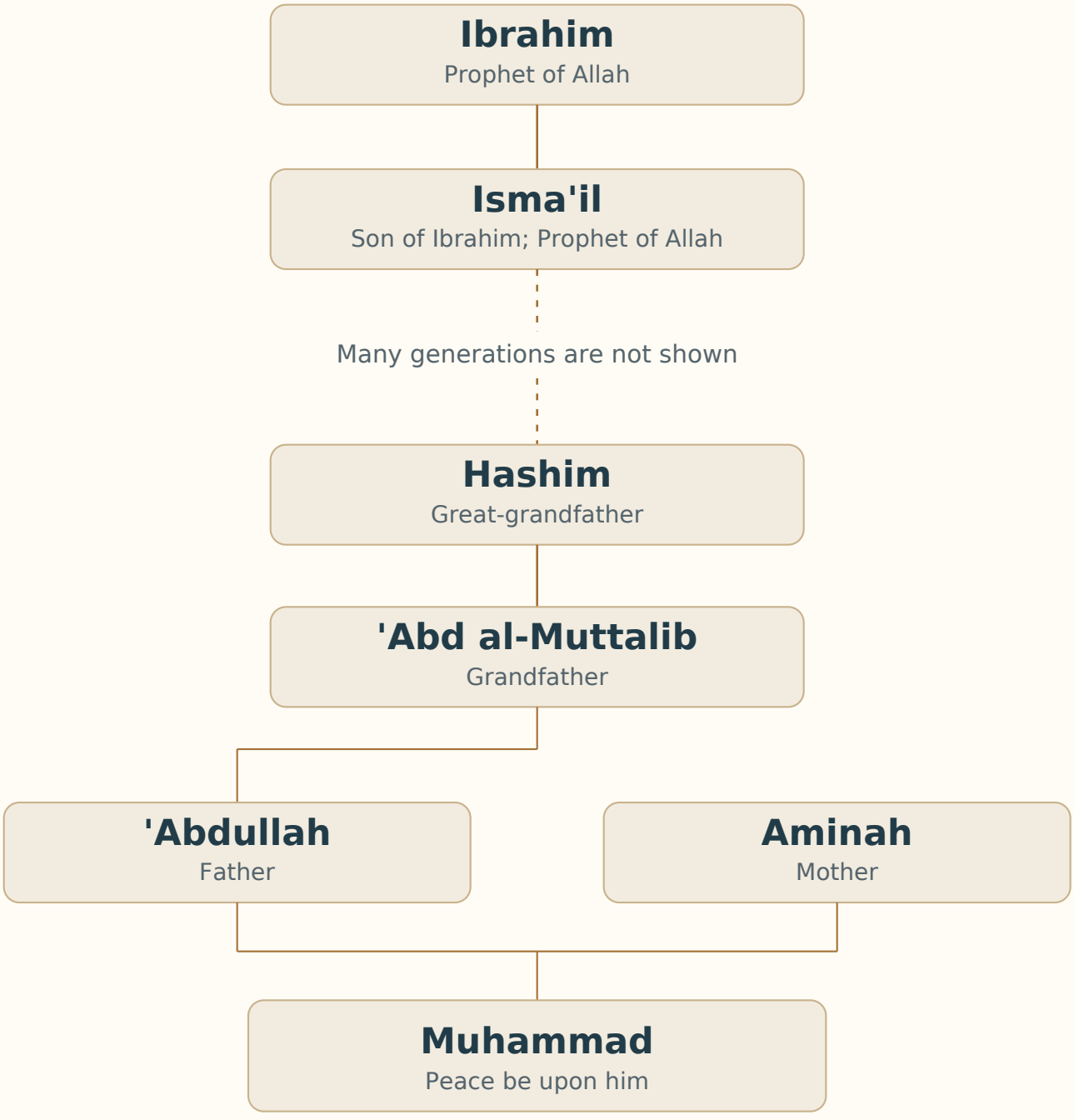
Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) belonged to Quraysh, the tribe connected with Makkah. His father was 'Abdullah, and his mother was Aminah. His grandfather was 'Abd al-Muttalib, and his great-grandfather was Hashim.

His family line goes back through Isma'il to Ibrahim. Remembering that connection helps us see that the message of worshipping Allah alone was not a new idea. It was the teaching of the earlier prophets too.

A family name can tell us about our past, but each person is responsible for their own choices. What matters before Allah is faith and good conduct, not showing off about our ancestors.

Reflect: What good quality would you like your family to be known for?

The Prophet's family tree



A solid line shows a parent-child connection. The dashed line skips many generations between Isma'il and Hashim.

Family line: Sahih Muslim 2276; standard seerah genealogies. This is a simplified ancestry chart, not a complete family tree.

Hashim, Who Shared Bread

Feeding guests and travellers

Pilgrims came to Makkah from far away. After a tiring journey, they needed food, water and a welcome. Hashim, the Prophet's great-grandfather, was remembered for helping to feed them.

Hashim's name is linked to the bread he crumbled into food for the pilgrims. His generosity made a difficult journey easier for other people. He also helped organise Quraysh's trading journeys.

We do not need to be wealthy to share. A drink of water, a place to sit or part of a meal can be a kindness. Generosity begins when we notice what another person needs.

Reflect: What could you share with a guest today?

'Abd al-Muttalib Finds Zamzam

A buried blessing

Zamzam is the well connected with Hajar and her son Isma'il. It brought water to Makkah's dry valley. Many generations later, its location had become hidden.

'Abd al-Muttalib was guided to dig for the well. He worked to uncover it, and Zamzam became a source of water for the people and pilgrims again.

Water is a blessing from Allah. A well can serve many people when its water is cared for and shared. Each time we drink, we can remember to be thankful and avoid wasting water.

Reflect: How can your family save water?

'Abdullah and Aminah

The Prophet's parents

'Abdullah was a son of 'Abd al-Muttalib. He married Aminah, who came from the clan of Banu Zuhrah. They would become the parents of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

'Abdullah died before his son was born. The baby would enter the world without ever meeting his father. His mother and relatives would care for him in Makkah.

An orphan is a child whose father has died. Losing a parent is a great sadness, and every child deserves love and care. The Prophet's early life helps us remember to be gentle with children who have experienced loss.

Reflect: How can you make another child feel included?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

A blessing becomes a way to help others when we share it.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 2 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. Which tribe did the Prophet belong to?

A. Quraysh
B. The Romans
C. The Persians

2. What was Hashim remembered for?

A. Building a palace
B. Feeding pilgrims
C. Leading Abrahah's army

3. What did 'Abd al-Muttalib uncover?

A. A forest
B. A ship
C. The well of Zamzam

4. Who was the Prophet's mother?

A. Aminah
B. Halimah
C. Khadijah

5. Who was the Prophet's father?

A. 'Abdullah
B. Abu Talib
C. Hashim

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Al-Furqan • Qur'an 25:74

وَٱلَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَٰجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّٰتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَٱجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا ﴿٧٤﴾

MEANING

They pray: Our Lord, make our spouses and children a joy to our hearts, and make us examples for those who are mindful of You.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbana hab lana min azwajina wa dhurriyyatina qurrata a'yunin waj'alna lil-muttaqina imama.

Read this family prayer together and discuss a kind example to set.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Name the Prophet's parents and grandfather.

2. Why was sharing water important in Makkah?

3. How can a family show generosity together?

4. Choose one way to include a child who feels alone.

When could you use this map's du'a?

The Year of the Elephant

Trust in Allah

STORY 01

Abrahah's Plan

STORY 02

The House Has a Lord

STORY 03

The Elephant Who Would Not Walk

STORY 04

The Year of the Elephant

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

An elephant is powerful. Can strength alone make an unfair plan succeed?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. Abrahah's Plan

2. The House Has a Lord

3. The Elephant Who Would Not Walk

4. The Year of the Elephant

Abrahah's Plan

Pride and jealousy

A ruler named Abrahah governed in Yemen, south of Makkah. He wanted people to visit a grand church. Yet the Arabs continued to honour the Ka'bah.

Abrahah gathered an army and set out towards Makkah. His aim was to destroy the sanctuary. The army included an elephant, an animal the people of Makkah could not easily fight.

A large army can frighten people, but being powerful does not make a person right. Pride can lead someone to harm others. This journey would show that human plans remain under Allah's power.

Reflect: How can pride turn a good ability into a harmful choice?

The House Has a Lord

Trusting Allah

As Abrahah's army approached, the people of Makkah faced a frightening danger. They did not have an army strong enough to defeat it.

'Abd al-Muttalib met Abrahah and asked for his camels to be returned. He is remembered for expressing trust that the Lord of the House would protect it.

The people moved away from the danger. Trusting Allah does not mean ignoring sensible steps. We ask for His help and do what we can to keep ourselves and others safe.

Reflect: Who is a trusted adult you can go to when you feel afraid?

The Elephant Who Would Not Walk

A plan stopped

The army had travelled a long way, but reaching Makkah did not mean its plan would succeed. The elephant would not advance towards the Ka'bah.

The soldiers could not force the outcome they wanted. An animal that seemed a sign of their strength became part of the story of their failure.

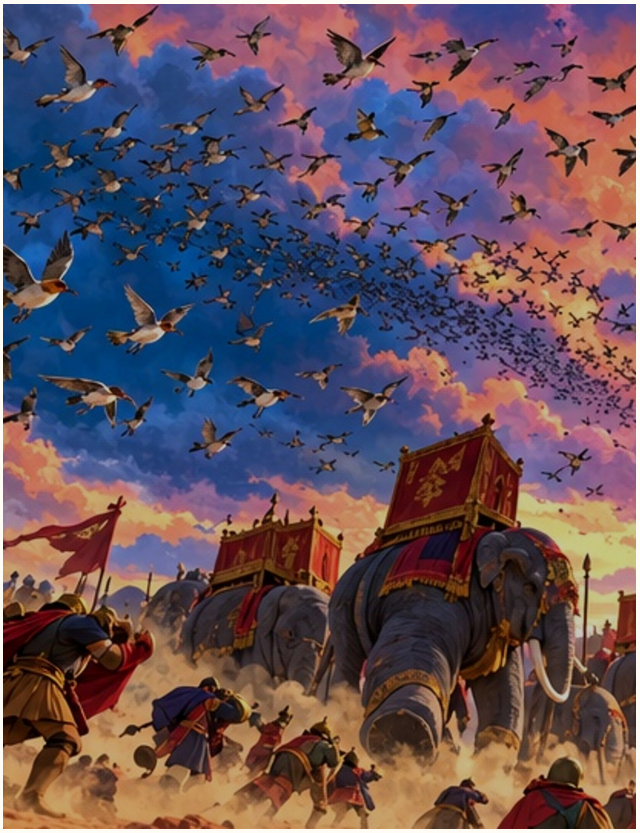
Surah al-Fil asks us to remember what Allah did to the people of the elephant. The lesson is not to admire the army's power, but to recognise that Allah is in control.

Reflect: What can this story teach us about bullying?

The Year of the Elephant

Allah protects the sanctuary

The Qur'an describes birds coming in flocks against the people of the elephant. They struck the army with stones of baked clay. The destructive plan failed, and the Ka'bah was not destroyed.



This event was remembered so strongly that people named the year after it: the Year of the Elephant. The Prophet's birth is traditionally placed in that year.

Read Surah al-Fil with an adult. Its five short verses remind us that an army's size cannot protect it from Allah. We should use whatever strength we have with humility and fairness.

Reflect: How could a strong person help someone weaker?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Allah's power is greater than the strength of any army.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 3 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. Where did Abrahah's army come from?

A. Yemen
B. Yathrib
C. Persia

2. What did Abrahah plan to destroy?

A. A market stall
B. The Ka'bah
C. A well in Yathrib

3. Which surah recalls this event?

A. Al-Fil
B. Al-Kawthar
C. Al-Falaq

4. What should we do when afraid?

A. Harm someone smaller
B. Ignore every danger
C. Ask Allah for help and seek safety

5. What happened to Abrahah's plan?

A. He destroyed the Ka'bah
B. He rebuilt the Ka'bah
C. It failed and the Ka'bah was not destroyed

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Al-Qasas • Qur'an 28:21

فَخَرَجَ مِنْهَا خَآئِفًا يَتَرَقَّبُ ۖ قَالَ رَبِّ نَجِّنِى مِنَ ٱلْقَوْمِ ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ ﴿٢١﴾

MEANING

Musa left the city, afraid and watchful. He prayed: My Lord, rescue me from the people who do wrong.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbi najjini mina l-qawmi z-zalimin.

This is Musa's prayer in the Qur'an. It was not a prayer spoken by the army in this story. If someone hurts you, tell a trusted adult.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Retell the event without focusing on frightening details.

2. Why does a powerful person still need humility?

3. How can you help someone being treated unfairly?

4. Read Surah al-Fil with an adult and share its main lesson.

When could you use this map's du'a?

A Blessed Birth

Gratitude and care

STORY 01

Good News Before His Birth

STORY 02

A Blessed Birth

STORY 03

Halimah's Blessed Journey

STORY 04

Out in the Desert

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Notice the tents and animals. What would a baby need in this desert home?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. Good News Before His Birth

2. A Blessed Birth

3. Halimah's Blessed Journey

4. Out in the Desert

Good News Before His Birth

Ibrahim's prayer

Long before Muhammad (peace be upon him) was born, Ibrahim and Isma'il prayed for a messenger from among their descendants. They asked Allah for someone who would teach His signs and wisdom.

The Qur'an also tells us that 'Isa gave good news of a messenger to come after him, named Ahmad. Muslims understand this as good news of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

Allah's plan reaches far beyond what one generation can see. We can pray for good things, keep doing what is right and trust Allah's wisdom about when and how our prayers are answered.

Reflect: What good thing could you pray for your family?

A Blessed Birth

Born in Makkah

Muhammad (peace be upon him) was born in Makkah. His mother was Aminah, and his father 'Abdullah had already died. His grandfather 'Abd al-Muttalib welcomed him into the family.

His birth is traditionally placed in the Year of the Elephant. The exact day and calendar date are discussed differently in historical accounts. What matters most for our journey is the life of faith and mercy that would follow.

A baby begins life needing care. Family and community can offer that care through feeding, protection, kindness and patient attention. Welcoming children is an opportunity to be grateful to Allah.

Reflect: How can an older child help welcome a new baby?

Halimah's Blessed Journey

Kindness to a child

Some families in Makkah sent their young children to be nursed and cared for in the desert. There they could grow in the open air and learn clear Arabic.

Halimah as-Sa'diyyah became a foster mother to Muhammad (peace be upon him). Her family faced difficult circumstances and noticed blessings while caring for him.

Her story is remembered as a story of care and welcome. Kindness is not only a feeling. It is the patient work of feeding, comforting and protecting someone who depends on us.

Reflect: Who has cared for you when you needed help?

Out in the Desert

Growing with a foster family

The young Muhammad (peace be upon him) spent part of his childhood with Halimah's family among Banu Sa'd. Desert life was different from the busy streets of Makkah.

Families lived close to their animals and depended on rain, pasture and water. Children learned by watching adults, helping in small ways and spending time with one another.

We can learn to notice the people who care for us each day. A thank-you, a helpful task and a gentle word can show gratitude. Allah's blessings include both the things we receive and the people who look after us.

Reflect: What small task could you do to help at home?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Every child deserves a gentle welcome and loving care.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 4 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. Who prayed for a messenger among their descendants?

A. Ibrahim and Isma'il
B. Abrahah and his army
C. The kings of Rome

2. Where was the Prophet born?

A. Yathrib
B. Makkah
C. Ta'if

3. Who was his foster mother?

A. Halimah as-Sa'diyyah
B. Khadijah
C. Umm Salamah

4. What does a baby need?

A. To be left alone
B. To win a contest
C. Gentle care and protection

5. Which tribe was Halimah's family part of?

A. The Romans
B. Banu Sa'd
C. The Persians

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Ali 'Imran • Qur'an 3:38

هُنَالِكَ دَعَا زَكَرِيَّا رَبَّهُۥ ۖ قَالَ رَبِّ هَبْ لِى مِن لَّدُنكَ
ذُرِّيَّةً طَيِّبَةً ۖ إِنَّكَ سَمِيعُ ٱلدُّعَآءِ ﴿٣٨﴾

MEANING

There Zakariyya prayed to his Lord: My Lord, grant me good offspring from You. You are the One who hears prayer.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbi hab li min ladunka dhurriyyatan tayyibatan innaka sami'u d-du'a.

This is Zakariyya's prayer. Families can ask Allah for goodness for their children.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. How did Halimah show kindness?

2. Say thank you to someone who cares for you.

3. What can you learn from Ibrahim's prayer?

4. Draw or describe a kind welcome for a new child.

When could you use this map's du'a?

Growing Up in Makkah

Patience and compassion

STORY 01

The Washing of the Heart

STORY 02

A Journey to Yathrib

STORY 03

Cared For and Loved

STORY 04

The Young Shepherd

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Look for the sheep and their path. What does a careful shepherd need to notice?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. The Washing of the Heart

2. A Journey to Yathrib

3. Cared For and Loved

4. The Young Shepherd

The Washing of the Heart

Allah prepares His Prophet

During the Prophet's childhood, an extraordinary event took place. An authentic report in Sahih Muslim tells us that Jibril came to him and washed his heart with Zamzam water in a golden basin.

This was a miracle and a special preparation from Allah. The other children were alarmed and went to tell the family. The Prophet (peace be upon him) was safe.

We do not picture the Prophet or the angel in this book. The basin and water are reminders of the report, not a drawing of the event. We can ask Allah to make our own hearts sincere and kind.

Reflect: Which habit can help you grow a kinder heart?

A Journey to Yathrib

Love and loss

When Muhammad (peace be upon him) was about six, his mother Aminah took him to Yathrib. This town of palm gardens would later become known as Madinah. Umm Ayman travelled with them.

On the return journey, Aminah became ill and died at al-Abwa'. Umm Ayman cared for the young boy and brought him back to Makkah. He had now lost both parents.

Loss can make a child feel deeply sad. Tears do not mean that a person lacks faith. We can listen, stay close and offer practical care to someone who is grieving.

Reflect: What gentle words could you say to a sad friend?

Cared For and Loved

His grandfather and uncle

After his mother's death, Muhammad (peace be upon him) was cared for by his grandfather 'Abd al-Muttalib. His grandfather loved him and gave him a place in the family.

When he was about eight, 'Abd al-Muttalib also died. His uncle Abu Talib then took responsibility for him. Abu Talib's family shared their home and cared for him as he grew.

The Prophet's childhood included painful losses and the kindness of relatives. A caring family or community cannot remove every sadness, but it can help a child feel safe and loved.

Reflect: How can your family help a child who needs care?

The Young Shepherd

Honest work

As a young person, Muhammad (peace be upon him) cared for sheep. Later, he told his companions that the prophets had tended sheep. He had tended them for the people of Makkah.

Sheep need patient attention. A shepherd watches for danger, looks for grazing and notices when an animal strays. The work calls for responsibility, even when no one is watching.

Small duties can help us practise good habits. Tidying a shared space, caring for an animal or finishing a task honestly are ways to become dependable. Useful work has dignity.

Reflect: Which daily responsibility can you do carefully?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Be patient with those who depend on you, and gentle with anyone who is grieving.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 5 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. What water is named in the washing-of-the-heart report?

A. Zamzam
B. Sea water
C. Rain from Ta'if

2. What was Yathrib later called?

A. Yemen
B. Madinah
C. Makkah

3. Who cared for him after his grandfather died?

A. Abrahah
B. Hashim
C. Abu Talib

4. What work did he do when young?

A. Cared for sheep
B. Built ships
C. Ruled an empire

5. How can we help a child who is grieving?

A. Tell them not to cry
B. Leave them without support
C. Listen gently and offer care

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Al-Isra • Qur'an 17:24

وَٱخۡفِضۡ لَهُمَا جَنَاحَ ٱلذُّلِّ مِنَ ٱلرَّحۡمَةِ وَقُل رَّبِّ
ٱرۡحَمۡهُمَا كَمَا رَبَّيَانِي صَغِيرٗا ٢٤

MEANING

Treat your parents with humility and mercy, and pray: My Lord, have mercy on them, as they cared for me when I was small.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbi rhamhuma kama rabbayani saghira.

The Qur'an teaches this prayer for parents. Pair your words with respectful, helpful actions.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. What does a shepherd's work teach about responsibility?

2. Why should we be gentle with someone who has lost a loved one?

3. Name a person who helps you feel safe.

4. Choose one helpful task to complete without being reminded.

When could you use this map's du'a?

A Young Man of Honour

Honesty and justice

STORY 01

The Monk Bahira

STORY 02

Protected by Allah

STORY 03

The Pact of Fairness

STORY 04

The Trustworthy One

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Notice the scales. Why does a marketplace need fair measures?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. The Monk Bahira

2. Protected by Allah

3. The Pact of Fairness

4. The Trustworthy One

The Monk Bahira

A story in the seerah

Trading caravans travelled north from Makkah towards the lands of al-Sham. The young Muhammad (peace be upon him) travelled with his uncle Abu Talib.

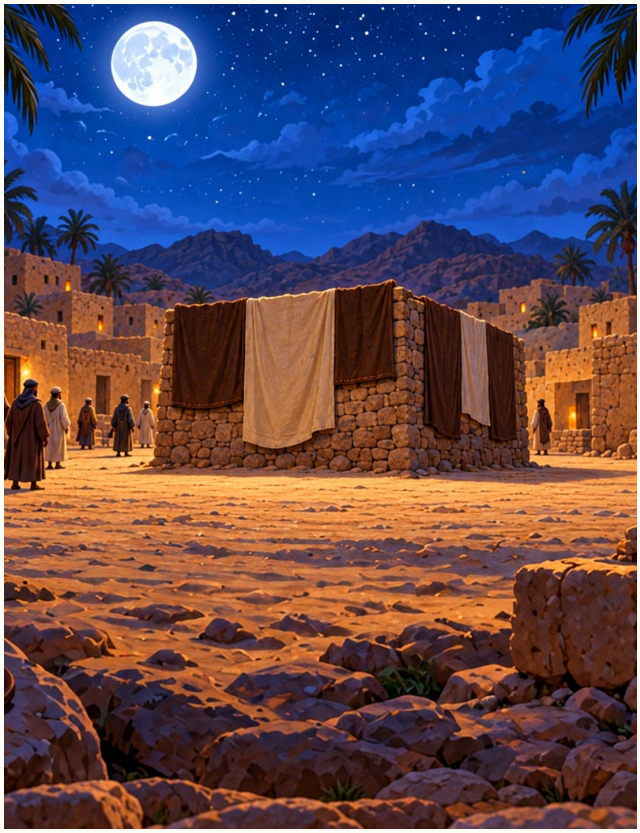
A monk called Bahira notices signs that lead him to speak about the boy's future. Scholars discuss the reports and their details, so we do not treat every familiar retelling as equally certain.

A careful learner can love the seerah and still ask where a story comes from. In the pages ahead, the first revelation is described through an authentic report in Sahih al-Bukhari.

Reflect: Why is checking a story's source a useful habit?

Protected by Allah

Growing in good character



Muhammad (peace be upon him) grew up among the people of Makkah before the Qur'an was revealed. Allah prepared him for the responsibility he would later carry.

He became known for honesty and dependable conduct. Even people who later opposed his message knew his good character. He did not join the worship of idols.

We cannot copy a prophet's special protection, but we can follow the good example of truthfulness and sound choices. When friends make a poor choice, we can step away politely and ask Allah for help to do what is right.

Reflect: How can you decline an unkind game politely?

The Pact of Fairness

Standing against injustice

A visitor to Makkah was treated unfairly in a business deal. He needed help, but he did not have a powerful local family to protect him.

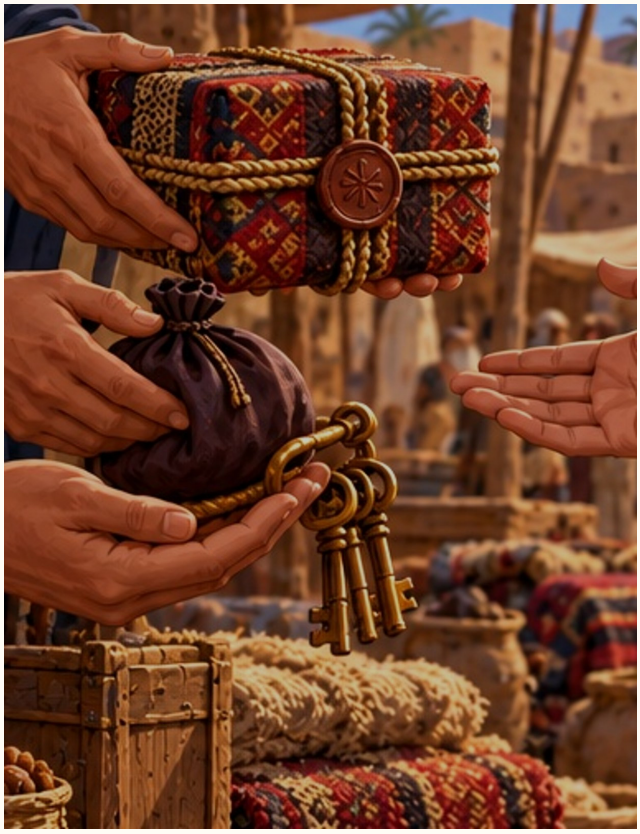
Some people agreed to stand together so that the oppressed could receive their rights. This agreement is remembered as Hilf al-Fudul, the Pact of Virtue. Muhammad (peace be upon him) took part as a young man.

Fairness should not depend on whether someone is rich, local or popular. We can stand beside a person who is being excluded, tell the truth about what happened and ask a responsible adult to help.

Reflect: What could you do if a new student is treated unfairly?

The Trustworthy One

Al-Amin



The people of Makkah knew Muhammad (peace be upon him) as al-Amin, the trustworthy one. A trustworthy person keeps what is placed in their care safe.

Honesty matters in business, friendship and family life. It means giving back what belongs to someone else, keeping a promise and speaking truthfully even when a lie might seem easier.

Trust grows through repeated actions. If we damage something, we can admit it and help put things right. If we borrow something, we can return it carefully. Being trustworthy is a daily choice.

Reflect: What should you do if you accidentally break something you borrowed?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Be trustworthy in small things and stand beside people who are treated unfairly.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 6 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. What does al-Amin mean?

A. The trustworthy one
B. The traveller
C. The poet

2. What was the pact meant to protect?

A. Only rich traders
B. The rights of people treated unfairly
C. A ruler's pride

3. What should a careful learner check?

A. Only how exciting a story is
B. How many pictures it has
C. Its source

4. Which action builds trust?

A. Returning something borrowed
B. Hiding a mistake
C. Breaking a promise

5. What is another name for the Pact of Virtue?

A. Hilf al-Fudul
B. The Year of the Elephant
C. The well of Zamzam

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Ali 'Imran • Qur'an 3:8

رَبَّنَا لَا تُزِغْ قُلُوبَنَا بَعْدَ إِذْ هَدَيْتَنَا وَهَبْ لَنَا مِن لَّدُنكَ
رَحْمَةً إِنَّكَ أَنتَ ٱلْوَهَّابُ ٨

MEANING

Our Lord, do not let our hearts turn away after You have guided us. Give us mercy from You; You are the Giver.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbana la tuzigh qulubana ba'da idh hadaytana wa hab lana min ladunka rahmatan innaka anta l-Wahhab.

Ask for a steady heart when you are choosing between right and wrong.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Tell a true example of someone keeping a promise.

2. How can you help a person whose voice is being ignored?

3. What should you do after making a mistake?

4. Practise one polite way to refuse a dishonest suggestion.

When could you use this map's du'a?

Trade and Marriage

Trust and kindness

STORY 01

The Honest Trader

STORY 02

Maysarah's Report

STORY 03

Khadijah

STORY 04

Zayd Chooses to Stay

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Look at the cloth, baskets and simple home. Which things suggest welcome and care?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. The Honest Trader

2. Maysarah's Report

3. Khadijah

4. Zayd Chooses to Stay

The Honest Trader

A journey for Khadijah

Khadijah bint Khuwaylid was a respected merchant in Makkah. She employed people to trade her goods. Hearing of Muhammad's honesty, she entrusted him with a trading journey.

He carried out the work faithfully. Trade was not only about earning money. It involved other people's property, promises, fair dealing and responsibility over a long journey.

His example reminds us that success should not come through cheating. In a game, a school task or a sale, we can aim to do well while staying truthful. A good result is better when it is earned honestly.

Reflect: What does honest success look like in a game?

Maysarah's Report

A reputation confirmed

Maysarah, who worked for Khadijah, accompanied Muhammad (peace be upon him) on the trading journey. On their return, he reported what he had observed.

The journey strengthened the picture of a dependable man who treated others well. Some retellings add extraordinary details; those details are not all equally established.

We can focus on the clear lesson: good character is seen in daily behaviour. The way we handle a task and treat the people beside us can speak more strongly than claims about ourselves.

Reflect: What might someone notice when working alongside you?

Khadijah

A home of support

Khadijah and Muhammad (peace be upon him) married before the beginning of revelation. He was twenty-five. She brought wisdom, generosity and strong character to their home.

Their marriage became a source of comfort and support. When the first revelation later came and he returned home shaken, Khadijah listened to him and reassured him. She was the first to believe in his message.

A kind home is built through listening, trust and care. Family members will not always feel the same way, but they can choose to speak gently and help one another.

Reflect: What helps someone feel listened to at home?

Zayd Chooses to Stay

Kindness remembered

Zayd ibn Harithah had been separated from his family and enslaved. He came into the household of Muhammad (peace be upon him), who later freed him.

Zayd's relatives came to find him. Having experienced such kind treatment, Zayd chose to remain with Muhammad. Their bond continued for many years.

This history includes painful injustice, as well as the importance of freedom and care. We should never treat another person as less worthy because of their background. Every person deserves dignity.

Reflect: How can you show respect to someone whose life is different from yours?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Honesty and kindness belong together, at work and at home.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 7 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. What work did Khadijah arrange?

A. A trading journey
B. An army expedition
C. A sea rescue

2. What quality made Muhammad dependable?

A. Pride
B. Honesty
C. Harshness

3. Who comforted him after the first revelation?

A. Abrahah
B. Bahira
C. Khadijah

4. How should people be treated?

A. With dignity
B. According only to wealth
C. According only to their tribe

5. Who reported on the trading journey to Khadijah?

A. Waraqah
B. Abrahah
C. Maysarah

Ayat to reflect on

Surah Az-Zukhruf • Qur'an 43:13-14

لِتَسْتَوُۥا۟ عَلَىٰ ظُهُورِهِۦ ثُمَّ تَذْكُرُوا۟ نِعْمَةَ رَبِّكُمْ إِذَا ٱسْتَوَيْتُمْ
عَلَيْهِ وَتَقُولُوا۟ سُبْحَٰنَ ٱلَّذِى سَخَّرَ لَنَا هَٰذَا وَمَا كُنَّا لَهُۥ
مُقْرِنِينَ ﴿١٣﴾
وَإِنَّآ إِلَىٰ رَبِّنَا لَمُنقَلِبُونَ ﴿١٤﴾

MEANING

So that you may sit firmly on their backs and remember your Lord's blessing when you are settled, saying: Glory to the One who made this available to us; we could not have mastered it ourselves. And to our Lord we will surely return.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Subhana lladhi sakhkhara lana hadha wa ma kunna lahu muqrinin. Wa inna ila rabbina la-munqalibun.

Remember Allah's blessings when riding or travelling. This is a Qur'anic passage, not the full travel supplication.

Uthmani text: Tanzil Project • tanzil.net

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Name two ways to be honest when trading or sharing.

2. How can a family member be a good listener?

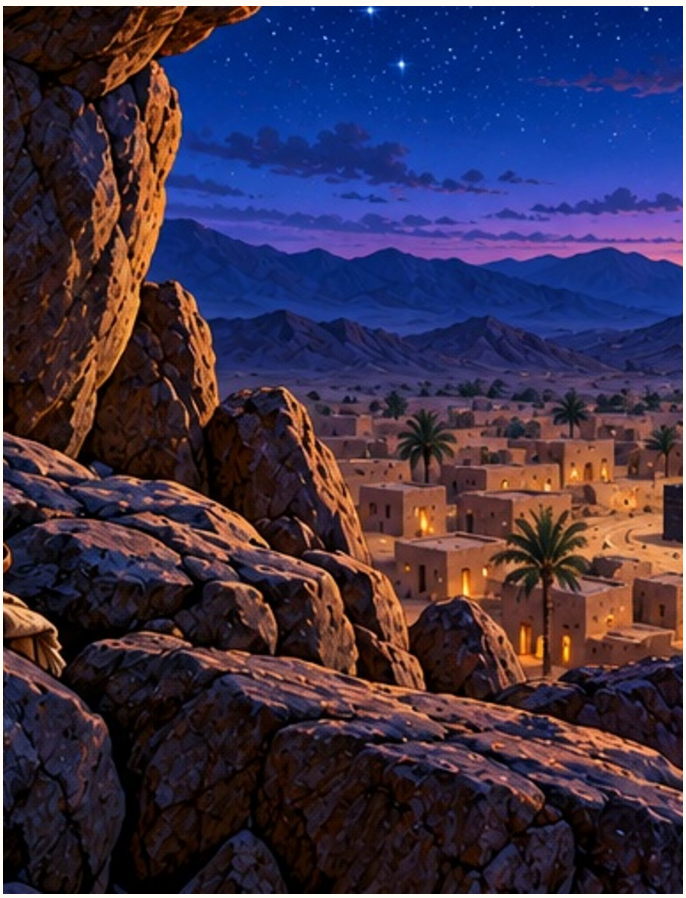
3. Why should everyone be treated with dignity?

4. Think of a journey. What blessings helped you travel safely?

When could you use this map's du'a?

Before the Message

Reflection and peace



STORY 01

The Black Stone

STORY 02

Seekers of the Truth

STORY 03

Dreams Like the Dawn

STORY 04

The Cave of Hira

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely

Look from the mountain towards the town. How can a quiet moment help you think?

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. The Black Stone

2. Seekers of the Truth

3. Dreams Like the Dawn

4. The Cave of Hira

The Black Stone

A peaceful solution

When Muhammad (peace be upon him) was about thirty-five, Quraysh rebuilt the Ka'bah. A dispute arose over which clan would have the honour of placing the Black Stone in its position.

They agreed to accept his judgement. He placed the stone on a cloth and asked representatives of the clans to lift it together. He then put it in place.

A quarrel that could have become dangerous was settled through a solution that included others. When we disagree, we can slow down, listen and find a fair way forward.

Reflect: How could two children share an important task fairly?

Seekers of the Truth

Questions that matter

Not everyone in Arabia was content with idol worship. Some people searched for the faith of Ibrahim and rejected the idea that carved objects should be worshipped.

Some people questioned the customs around them and looked for truth. Searching honestly takes courage, especially when friends or neighbours think differently.

A question is a chance to learn. We can ask parents, teachers and knowledgeable people for help. We should be ready to listen, check evidence and admit when we do not yet know.

Reflect: What thoughtful question would you like to ask a teacher?

Dreams Like the Dawn

The beginning draws near

An authentic report from 'Aishah describes the beginning of revelation. The Prophet (peace be upon him) first experienced truthful dreams that came true clearly, like the light of dawn.

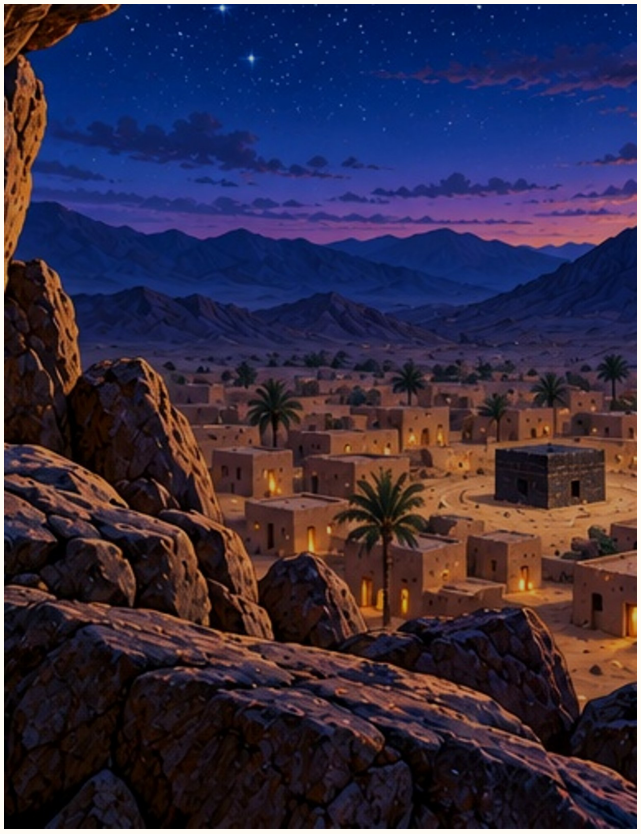
These dreams were part of his special preparation for prophethood. Ordinary dreams do not make someone a prophet and do not create new religious teachings.

As the time drew near, he came to love periods of quiet worship. Our journey is now approaching the cave of Hira, where the first words of the Qur'an would be revealed.

Reflect: Why should we learn religion from reliable sources rather than dreams?

The Cave of Hira

Time for reflection



Outside Makkah stood a mountain with the cave of Hira. Muhammad (peace be upon him) spent periods there in worship before he received revelation. He took provisions with him and returned to his family.

The cave was a quiet place above the busy town. He was not escaping responsibility; he still cared for his household. Allah was preparing him for a message that would reach far beyond Makkah.

We do not need to climb a mountain to have a thoughtful moment. A little quiet time can help us notice our blessings, read, pray and think about how we treat others.

Reflect: Where can you have a calm moment to read or reflect?

A lesson to carry

REMEMBER THIS

Seek truth carefully, and look for peaceful ways to resolve a disagreement.

Explain this lesson in your own words. How could you use it today?

One good action I can practise

Map 8 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. What caused the dispute at the Ka'bah?

A. Placing the Black Stone
B. Choosing a market day
C. Digging a new well

2. What helped settle it?

A. A louder argument
B. A fair shared task
C. Ignoring everyone

3. Which cave is linked with the first revelation?

A. Thawr
B. Uhud
C. Hira

4. Do ordinary dreams create religious teachings?

A. No
B. Yes
C. Only when repeated

5. What did the clans lift together?

A. A cloth holding the Black Stone
B. A basket of dates
C. A new well cover

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Al-Isra • Qur'an 17:80

وَقُل رَّبِّ أَدْخِلْنِي مُدْخَلَ صِدْقٍ وَأَخْرِجْنِي مُخْرَجَ
صِدْقٍ وَاجْعَل لِّي مِن لَّدُنكَ سُلْطَانًا نَّصِيرًا ﴿٨٠﴾

MEANING

And say: My Lord, let me enter truthfully and leave truthfully, and grant me supporting strength from You.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbi adkhilni mudkhala sidqin wa akhrijni mukhraja sidqin waj'al li min ladunka sultanan nasira.

Ask Allah for truthfulness and help as you begin a good task.

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Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Suggest a peaceful solution to a disagreement about taking turns.

2. What is the difference between asking a question and mocking someone?

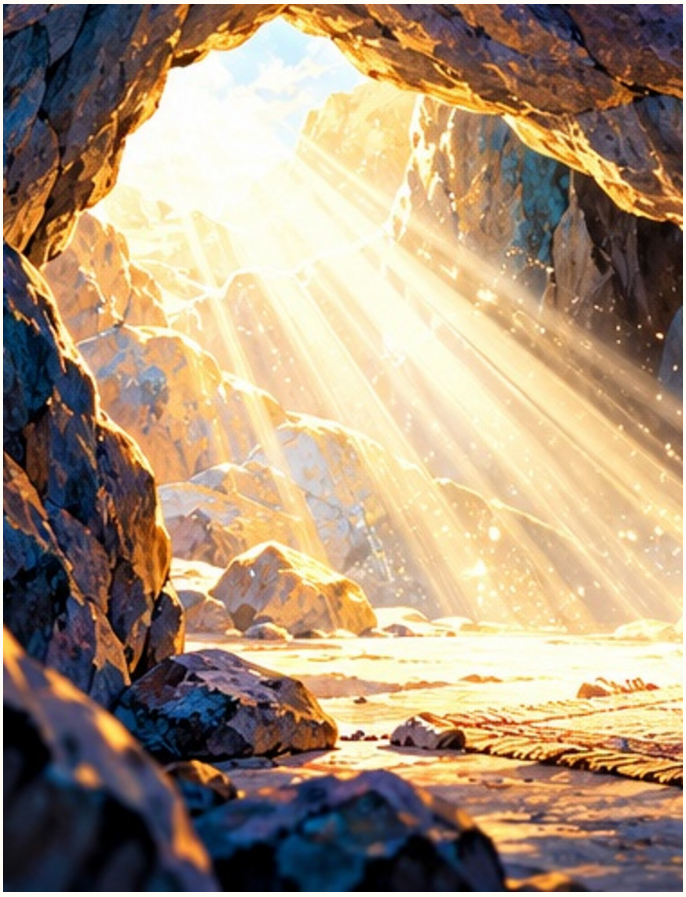
3. Name a reliable person who can help you learn.

4. Take a quiet minute and name three blessings.

When could you use this map's du'a?

The First Revelation

Learning and courage



STORY 01

Read!

STORY 02

Comfort from Khadijah

STORY 03

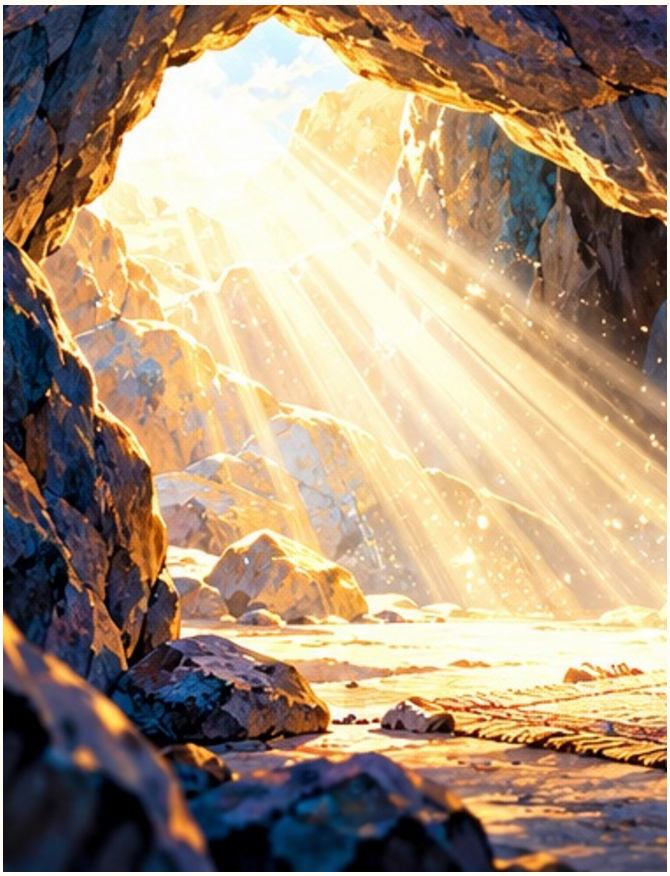
Waraqah's Words

STORY 04

Arise and Warn

Read. Reflect. Put one good lesson into practice.

Look closely



Notice the light at the cave entrance. The scene shows a place, never the Prophet or Jibril.

What else do you notice? Tell someone before turning the page.

YOUR FOUR STORY QUESTS

1. Read!

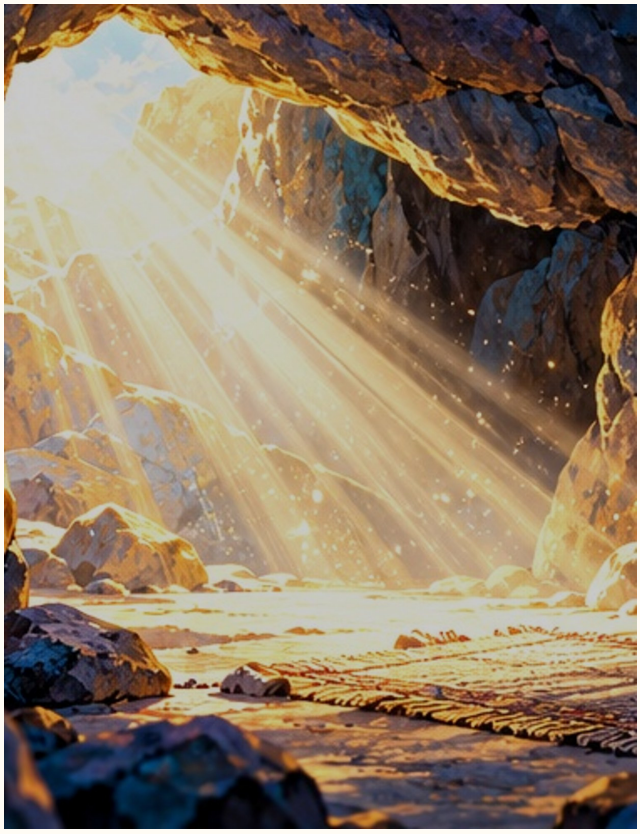
2. Comfort from Khadijah

3. Waraqah's Words

4. Arise and Warn

Read!

The first words revealed



Muhammad (peace be upon him) was forty when the first revelation came. While he was in the cave of Hira, the angel Jibril came to him with a command to read. He replied that he was not a reader.

After the encounter, Jibril recited the opening verses of Surah al-'Alaq. They speak of reading in the name of the Lord who created, and of Allah teaching people what they did not know.

These were the first revealed words of the Qur'an. The Prophet returned home shaken by what had happened. A great responsibility had begun.

Reflect: What does this beginning teach us about learning?

Comfort from Khadijah

A gentle response

The Prophet (peace be upon him) returned to Khadijah and asked to be covered. When his fear eased, he told her what had happened. She listened and reassured him.

Khadijah reminded him of his good character: he cared for relatives, helped people in need, welcomed guests and stood beside people in difficulty. She did not dismiss his feelings.

Her kindness teaches us how to respond when someone is frightened. We can listen calmly, speak gently and help them find trustworthy support. Comfort is an act of care.

Reflect: How can you show that you are listening to a worried person?

Waraqah's Words

Understanding the message

Khadijah took the Prophet (peace be upon him) to her cousin Waraqah ibn Nawfal. Waraqah knew earlier scripture and listened to the account of what had happened in the cave.

He recognised the angel who had brought revelation to Musa. He also warned that carrying the message would bring opposition. The path ahead would need courage and patience.

The report of this meeting is found in Sahih al-Bukhari. It connects the first revelation with the earlier prophets: Allah's messengers called people to worship Him and live rightly.

Reflect: Why can doing the right thing sometimes require courage?

Arise and Warn

The mission begins

After the first revelation, there was a pause. Later, the Prophet (peace be upon him) received the opening commands of Surah al-Muddaththir: he was to rise, warn people and honour his Lord.

The message was not only for a quiet moment in a cave. It would guide belief, worship, families, friendships and the way people treated the vulnerable.

Book One ends at the beginning of that mission. In Book Two, we meet the first believers and follow the courage of a growing community. Carry this lesson with you: learn what is good, then practise it with kindness.

Reflect: What is one good thing you learned that you can practise today?

Map 9 quest check

Try each question, then talk about why the answer fits.

1. How old was the Prophet at the first revelation?

A. Forty
B. Twenty-five
C. Six

2. Which surah's first verses were revealed at Hira?

A. Al-Fil
B. Al-'Alaq
C. Al-Fatihah

3. Who brought the revelation?

A. Waraqah
B. Abu Talib
C. Jibril

4. What did Khadijah do when he was afraid?

A. Listened and reassured him
B. Ignored him
C. Laughed at him

5. Who did Khadijah take the Prophet to meet?

A. Abrahah
B. Waraqah ibn Nawfal
C. Hashim

An ayah to reflect on

Surah Ta-Ha • Qur'an 20:114

فَتَعَٰلَى ٱللَّهُ ٱلْمَلِكُ ٱلْحَقُّ ۗ وَلَا تَعْجَلْ بِٱلْقُرْءَانِ مِن قَبْلِ
أَن يُقْضَىٰٓ إِلَيْكَ وَحْيُهُۥ ۖ وَقُل رَّبِّ زِدْنِى عِلْمًا ﴿١١٤﴾

MEANING

Exalted is Allah, the true King. Do not hurry to recite the Qur'an before its revelation to you is complete, and say: My Lord, increase me in knowledge.

DU'A READING AID (FROM THE AYAH)

Rabbi zidni 'ilma.

Say this as you begin learning, then give your lesson careful attention.

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Pause and reflect

What are you asking Allah for in this du'a?

Think of a time when you could use this du'a.

Think, talk & do

Say your answers aloud, write them down or draw. Take your time.

1. Retell the first revelation in three clear steps.

2. Name two good qualities Khadijah remembered.

3. What helps you keep learning when something feels difficult?

4. Choose one kind action to carry into Book Two.

When could you use this map's du'a?

Word treasure • 1

Seerah

The life and biography of the Prophet.

Tawhid

Worshipping Allah alone.

Ka'bah

The sacred House in Makkah; Muslims face it in prayer.

Quraysh

The Prophet's tribe in Makkah.

Jahiliyyah

The time of ignorance before Islam.

Bedouin

People traditionally living a travelling desert life.

Oasis

A place in a dry land where water supports life.

Caravan

People and animals travelling together.

Zamzam

The blessed well in Makkah.

Pilgrim

A person travelling to a sacred place for worship.

Orphan

In this context, a child whose father has died.

Foster family

A family who cares for a child.

Word treasure • 2

Al-Amin

The trustworthy one.

Justice

Giving people their rights and acting fairly.

Dignity

The worth and respect every person deserves.

Du'a

Calling on Allah in prayer.

Hira

The cave linked with the first revelation.

Revelation

A message Allah gives to His prophets.

Jibril

The angel who brought revelation.

Qur'an

Allah's revelation to Prophet Muhammad.

Hadith

A report of the Prophet's words, actions or approval.

Sabr

Patience and perseverance.

Shukr

Thankfulness to Allah.

Amanah

A trust or responsibility to care for.

Quest answer key

A family helper: discuss the reason, not only the letter.

Map 1

1. Seas • 2. Ibrahim and Isma'il • 3. Worshipping Allah alone • 4. Protecting a person's rights • 5. To find drinking water

Map 2

1. Quraysh • 2. Feeding pilgrims • 3. The well of Zamzam • 4. Aminah • 5. 'Abdullah

Map 3

1. Yemen • 2. The Ka'bah • 3. Al-Fil • 4. Ask Allah for help and seek safety • 5. It failed and the Ka'bah was not destroyed

Map 4

1. Ibrahim and Isma'il • 2. Makkah • 3. Halimah as-Sa'diyyah • 4. Gentle care and protection • 5. Banu Sa'd

Map 5

1. Zamzam • 2. Madinah • 3. Abu Talib • 4. Cared for sheep • 5. Listen gently and offer care

Map 6

1. The trustworthy one • 2. The rights of people treated unfairly • 3. Its source • 4. Returning something borrowed • 5. Hilf al-Fudul

Map 7

1. A trading journey • 2. Honesty • 3. Khadijah • 4. With dignity • 5. Maysarah

Map 8

1. Placing the Black Stone • 2. A fair shared task • 3. Hira • 4. No • 5. A cloth holding the Black Stone

Map 9

1. Forty • 2. Al-'Alaq • 3. Jibril • 4. Listened and reassured him • 5. Waraqah ibn Nawfal

Book One complete!

You have explored nine maps and thirty-six stories, from the world of early Arabia to the beginning of revelation.

What surprised you? Which person showed kindness? Which lesson will you practise next?

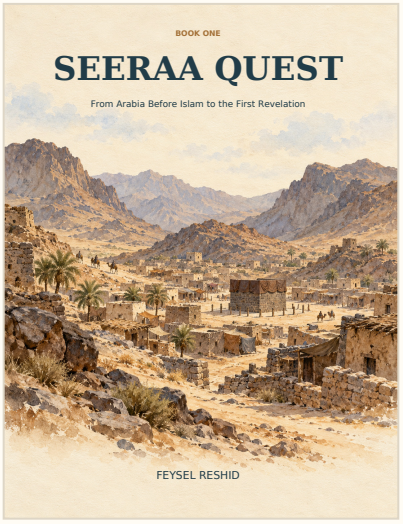
Continue with Book Two: from the first believers to the first pledge of 'Aqabah.

Keep learning. Keep asking. Keep doing good.

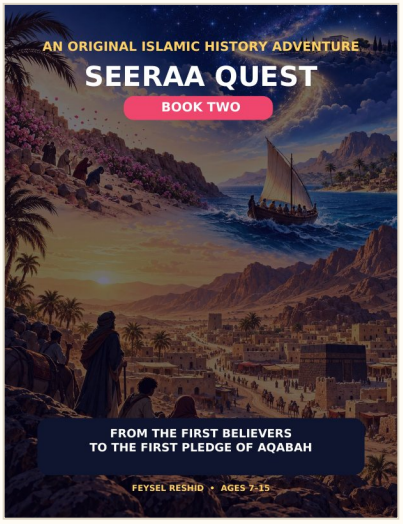
THE COMPLETE COLLECTION

SEERAA QUEST

5 BOOKS • 45 MAPS • 180 STORIES



BOOK 1



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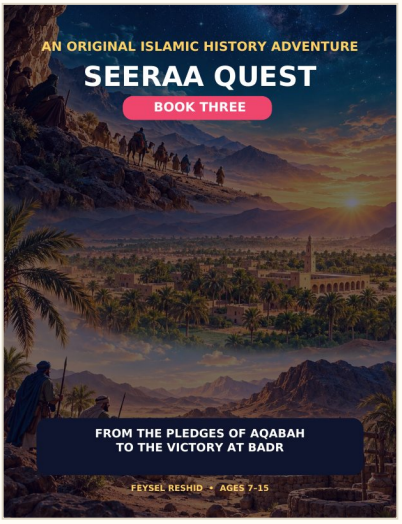

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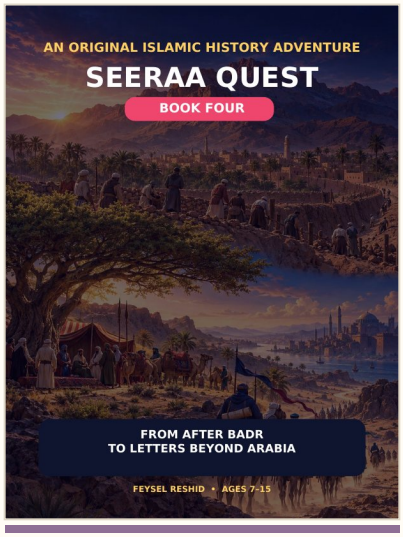
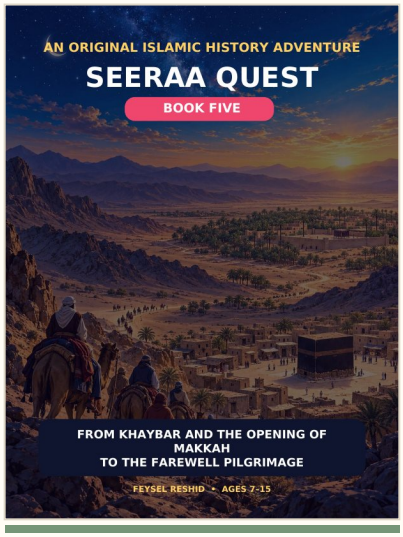


BOOK 4



BOOK 5

Explore. Learn. Reflect. Remember.

FEYSEL RESHID